

Faith over fear, God's power in our lives.

Transcript of the God's Design podcast episode

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Good day and welcome to this podcast. I'm your host, Ashton. Today we're going to continue with a series called Faith Over Fear. Today we're going to look at the role of power in our lives. In all situations that we face, we either operate with the power of God or we are trapped by fear in those particular situations. 2 Timothy 1 verse 7 reads, For God had not given us the spirit of fear, but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind. The word power in the text translated from the Greek means douninous.

It means power. It means might. It means strength. Use of physical power. It means force. It means having the ability. It means having energy. It means having the power to do marvelous deeds and works. Efficacy. The word helps translate the word as having ability. To be able to perform the duties that you have been given. The power to achieve. The power to apply the Lord's inherent abilities. And also the power through God's ability. The word power is used 120 times in the New Testament.

Many Christians struggle with this particular saying. They always say things like, I can't do it, or it seems impossible. People, especially when they're working in the vineyard of the Lord, and there are tasks for them to do, but they just don't see a way of how they can accomplish it. This statement directly violates the power that God has given you and placed inside of you. People who want to give up because they are tired or because they have stopped believing in the will of God for their lives are not lining up with the victory that God has for them in their life.

Your words are based on fear. You fear that the outcome which you are hoping for may never be achieved. But God says that I have given you my power. The power God has placed inside of you is his own ability for you to accomplish your tasks. Romans 1 verse 6 says, For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ, for it is a power of God to salvation for everyone who believes, for the Jews first and also for the Greek. The source of this power you have inside of you is heavenly, given to all who believe in Christ Jesus.

The role of this power is to make us stand victoriously in the face of our situations and not cower. The presence of fear therefore or the delapidating fear that we experience sometimes is then the very absence of God within our situations. It means that we are not experiencing the love of God. It means we are not trusting God for his power to get us through difficult situations. In order for us to overcome any difficult situations, Situations, we need to have power.

That particular power boosts our will to overcome and succeed what is before us. God has given us a choice. We can be victims or we can be victors. But depending on what we choose to believe and receive from Him will ultimately determine if we lay there defeated or we're standing over our enemies in victory. Luke 8 verse 25 says, But He said to them, Where is your faith? And they were afraid and marveled, saying to one another, Who can this be? For He commands even the winds and the water, and they obey Him.

The first thing Jesus addressed inside of His disciples was their fear. They had moved from a position of faith to a position of fear. Mark 5 verse 36 says, As soon as Jesus heard the word that was spoken, He said to the ruler of the synagogue, Do not be afraid, only believe. The word afraid in the Greek says, To put to flight, frightened, something that is too terrifying. Strong says, Struck with fear, seized with alarm. Jesus was constantly teaching His disciples and the people around Him that they should not be seized with fear, but they should only believe in God.

And how true is it for us today when we hear of a bad situation or terrible news of a loved one, a friend, a family, and the first thing that comes to mind, we are seized with fear, we are seized with horror, and instead of believing God, we then succumb to our fears. As Christians, we are all at different levels in our life when it comes to having faith over fear. The other night, I had put my phone on charge, and I had got a yellow warning sign by the connector.

So I unplugged it and I plugged it in again, and it said the same thing, warning. So I followed the cable to the charger and everything seemed fine. But when I pushed the cable in, I realized that it wasn't fully pushed in, so there was a trickle charge. And that is the case with many Christians, is that we are not fully plugged in to the source and the power of God. Even though my phone appeared to be properly plugged in, the receiver was telling me, warning, I am not receiving enough power.

Although the power source, the adapter, was connected and was receiving 100% of the power, You and I as Christians, if we allow our fears to get in the way, these fears are just like the cable that was not properly connected to the power source. We are not fully powered by the source. We have all these other things in between the source of the power and us receiving the

power, and therefore we do not operate as God wants us to operate. The supply of God's power is always consistent in our lives.

But we, through fear, are not properly drawing. That power God has given us. Psalm 56 verse 11 reads, In God I have put my trust, and I will not be afraid what man can do unto me. Just like the phone and the cable, if we try to do anything in our own strength, eventually we will run out of power. But if we stay connected to the source, we will have an unlimited amount of power. At our disposal for the task and the situations that are before us. It is your job to rely on God solely for this power.

As Ephesians 6 verse 10 reads, Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might. In our covenant relationship with God, God is the stronger partner. It is because of His strength that we are able to face all situations and all enemies that are coming head on in our lives. We should never lean on our own understanding and our own strength. The word of God says, not by strength, not by might, but by my spirit. God bless you.